

LIVE

Learning Space

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8th March, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

10th WEEK



SOFTENING STAND ON CHINA

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... India and its Neighborhood- Relations.

6

Rolling Over?

India should conduct ties with China from a position of strength

In a turn of events that portrays government as the opposite of the tough image it has been projecting in the international arena, the Tibetan government-in-exile has called off two of its programmes in Delhi marking 60 years in exile of the Dalai Lama. While an interfaith prayer at Rajghat has been cancelled, a 'Thank You India' event has been shifted to Dharamsala. This comes after reports emerged that foreign secretary Vijay Gokhale had sent a note to cabinet secretary PK Sinha to discourage senior leaders and government officials from attending Tibet-related activities as India-China relations were going through a sensitive phase. Sinha had subsequently sent a directive to this effect to the Centre and states.



While it's true that New Delhi-Beijing ties are in a delicate position after the 73 day Doklam standoff last year and China's growing presence in the Indian Ocean region – an upcoming Chinese base in the Maldives being the latest point of concern – it does India no good to be seen bending to Chinese pressure. Government can argue that its position on the Dalai Lama hasn't changed. But the cancellation of the Delhi events to avoid Beijing's displeasure signals weakness on New Delhi's part.

China, after all, does India no favours. It regularly shields anti-Indian terrorists and thwarts New Delhi in multiple other ways at international fora. It provides limited market access to India while making the most of the Indian market. The only way India can secure its own interests is by standing up to Chinese pressure. Rolling over and restricting Tibetan activities to please Beijing is a recipe for disaster. If this is allowed to become a habit, China will continually play the displeasure card to strategically restrain India.



THE TIMES OF INDIA

7th March, 2018

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NEWS ITEM OF JANUARY 2017

SALIENT POINTS



- Himachal Pradesh Govt. declared Dharamshala as the 2nd Capital of Himachal Pradesh.
- Winter session of State Legislature will be held in Dharamshala.
- It is also the place where Tibetan spiritual guru Dalai Lama lives and headquarters of Central Tibetan Administration, where the Tibetan Govt. in Exile functions.
- Himachal Pradesh is the 3rd State in India to declare two capitals after Maharashtra (Mumbai, Nagpur) and Jammu & Kashmir (Srinagar, Jammu)



AFGHANISTAN

JAMMU AND KASHMIR

CHINA

Dharamshala
HIMACHAL PRADESH

PAKISTAN

PUNJAB

UTTARAKHAND

HARYANA

N E P A L



India-China ties are in delicate situation after 73-day Doklam Stand-off.

TWO INCIDENTS, WHICH ARE QUITE OPPOSITE TO THE TOUGH STANCE!

- 1 Tibetan Government-in-exile called off two of its programmes in Delhi marking 60 years in exile of the Dalai Lama.
- 2 Interfaith prayer at Rajghat has been cancelled. A 'Thank You India' event has been shifted to Dharamshala.
- 3 Moreover, Foreign Secretary Vijay Gokhale sent a note to Cabinet Secretary PK Sinha to discourage Senior leaders and Government Officials from attending Tibet-related activities.
- 4 Subsequently, the Cabinet Secretary sent a directive to this effect to the Centre and the States.



POINTS OF CONCERN

- 1 China's growing presence in the Indian Ocean region is the Point of Concern for India.
- 2 China's ocean observation station is coming up at Maldives.
- 3 China regularly shields anti-Indian terrorists. It also thwarts India in multiple other ways at International Fora.
- 4 It provides limited market access to India, while ensuring free exports to India to capture Indian Market.

A map showing the island of Sri Lanka in the upper right and the Maldives archipelago in the lower left, both in yellow against a blue background. A red line points from a specific island in the Maldives to a text box.

SRI
LANKA

Makunudhoo Island

MALDIVES



IS IT SOFTENING OF THE STANCE?

- 1 Cancellation of the Delhi events to avoid Beijing's displeasure signals weakness on New Delhi's part.
- 2 Rolling over and restricting Tibetan activities to please Beijing is a recipe for disaster.
- 3 If this is allowed to become a habit, China will continually play the displeasure card to strategically restrain India.

It does India no good to be seen bending to Chinese pressure.

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Learning Space

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